

## Easily configurable to specific industry needs

Most tools generally focus on the general manufacturing segment and service industry. One of the biggest advantages of using open-source BI was the ease with which the tool could be configured as per the construction industry and product demands. “We needed specific changes so that our business process was well accommodated, and the application was intuitive to the user. We wanted a tool that had all the basic features, but could be configured to create the specific analyses we need (in case of BI tool). In Pentaho BI, this was not a problem, as the analysis is driven from the Data Warehouse and if that is designed well, getting the required analysis is not an issue. In case of the CRM system, I had to ask BusinessInsight Consulting to create a new module that would track different construction projects, and be able to maintain a history of the interactions we have with customers regarding a particular apartment,” says Banthia.

## Smart decisions

Further, the use of an open-source BI tool ensured faster and more accurate reports, resulting in quick decision-making. The ability to freely explore business information by drilling into and cross-tabulating data; the speed-of-thought response times to complex analytical queries; the ability to view information multi-dimensionally, choosing specific metrics and attributes to analyse; and the choice of deploying it stand-alone or integrated with other products in Pentaho BI was a great boon to Manav Promoters. “Earlier, almost all our analysis was done using MS Excel. Apart from the inherent issues of errors creeping in when a report is manually compiled from different data sources, we took two to three weeks to create relevant reports. With Pentaho BI, these reports are available on demand, without any manual intervention. In barely 20 minutes, I can get all kinds of permutations and combinations of reports that I desire,” says Banthia.

“We are in the process of implementing a purchase system that would ensure that Manav is able to aggregate its purchase requirements, and is able to negotiate favourable terms with the vendors. A Business Intelligence system that provides

comparisons of different vendors and their performance history is also envisaged, which would be further helpful in selecting the right vendors,” adds Sharma.

## Cost effective

Cost efficiency has been one of the biggest advantages reaped by Manav Promoters. “Had we gone in for a proprietary tool for BI, database management and now CRM, the licence cost plus the implementation cost would have forced us to postpone the plan—perhaps indefinitely. Using open-source tools, we have saved at least 60 per cent. The use of open-source technology has put enterprise-class software within my reach. With the same budget, I can envision using more tools that would help me manage and track the growth of the company,” says Banthia.

## Support no longer an issue

Adoption of open-source technology often comes with maintenance and training issues, but Manav Promoters’ experience has been otherwise. “The whole maintenance and training issue is handled by BIC. I think if one opts for a good support vendor, there are no issues with open source. The tools become literally like plug and play,” says Banthia.

## Future plans

Looking ahead, Manav Promoters intends to continue to embrace open-source technology. After the successful implementation of SugarCRM, the company plans to extend Pentaho BI to analyse the SugarCRM data. Further, it is also considering using an open-source ERP tool (on the Ubuntu OS platform). As open source continues to help Manav Promoters scale new heights, the company continues to welcome it with open arms! 

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The author loves to experiment, and writing for LINUX For You is her latest experiment—so beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.

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